soSci der onlineFragebogen

Player Perceptions of Game HUD Design

A103

Welcome to this study on game interfaces in RPG and action-adventure titles.

In this study, you will watch six gameplay clips (approximately 90 seconds each) and then answer questions about how the interface feels and how well it supports your experience.
Participation is voluntary and anonymous. You may stop at any time, for any reason, without any disadvantages. Your responses will be used exclusively for a student research project at the University of Bonn.

You must be at least **18 years old** to participate.
Please make sure you are in a quiet environment and can watch the videos in full, with sound.
The study will take approximately **20 minutes** to complete.

I have read the information above and agree to participate in this study.

A102

- ◯ Yes, I agree
- ◯ No, I do not agree

2 Active Filter(s)

Filter A102/F1

If any of the following options is selected: **2**

Then display the text **A104** and finish the interview, after the next button was clicked

Filter A102/F2

If any of the following options is selected: **1**

Then jump to page **A301?** after the next button was clicked

A201

1. How old are you? (in years)

A202

2. What is your gender?

- ◯ Female
- ◯ Male
- ◯ Non-binary
- ◯ Diverse/ intersex
- ◯ Prefer not to say
- ◯ Other, please specify:

A203

3. On average, how many hours per week do you play video games?

- ◯ less than 7 hours
- ◯ 7-14 hours
- ◯ 15-20 hours
- ◯ 21 hours or more

A204

4. Approximately how many years have you played video games?

A205

5. Which platforms do you mainly play on? (please select all that apply)

- ☐ PC
- ☐ PlayStation
- ☐ Xbox
- ☐ Nintendo
- ☐ Mobile
- ☐ Other

A206

6. How would you describe yourself as a player?

- ◯ Casual (I only play occasionally / to relax)
- ◯ Core (I play regularly; gaming is an important hobby)
- ◯ Competitive (play ambitiously, often in competitive multiplayer / ranked)

7. How interested are you in action-adventure and role-playing games? A207

	Not at all interested	Slightly interested	Neutral	Interested	Very Interested
Action and Action-Adventure Games	○	○	○	○	○
Role-Playing Games	○	○	○	○	○

Page 03

PHP code

```
question('A301');                           // Zettel in Zufallsreihenfolge ziehen
$pages = valueList('A301', NULL, 'label');  // Gezogene Seitenkennungen auslesen
setPageOrder($pages, 'UIPREF');            // Erst diese Seiten, dann weiter mit Seite UI_PREF
```

question('A301')

Page 04

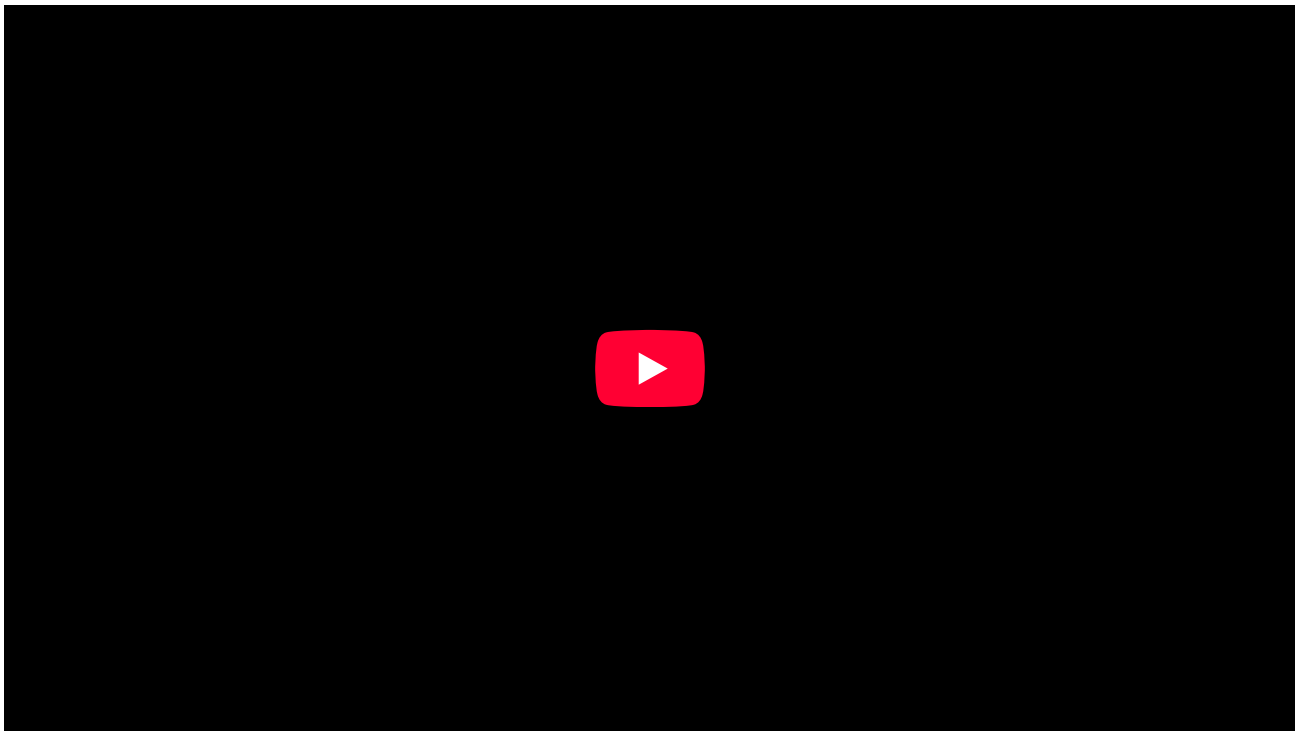
C1

A406

Please watch the following video clip carefully and in full screen.

Afterwards, you will be asked questions about this Clip.

Game Title: Ghost of Yotei



If the video does not load, click here.

A401

Game familiarity

	Never seen or played	Seen it, but never played	Played a little / know the basics	Played several times	Played a lot / know it very well
How familiar are you with this game?	○	○	○	○	○

A407

What we mean by interface (HUD)

*In video games, a **head-up display (HUD)** or in this study **interface** is the on-screen overlay that shows essential gameplay information—such as health, ammo, objectives, and minimaps—so players can make decisions without leaving the main action.*

A402

In the presented clip, with this interface...

	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
...I would feel **absorbed** in the gameplay.	○	○	○	○	○
...it would be **easy** for me to **tune out** my real-world surroundings.	○	○	○	○	○
...I would feel **present** in the game world.	○	○	○	○	○
...it would be **easy** for me to **stay focused** on the gameplay.	○	○	○	○	○

A403

Regarding the on-screen interface in the clip...

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly agree
...it is **clear** to me what is happening in the situation shown.	○	○	○	○	○
...the interface **provides** the information I would need to play effectively.	○	○	○	○	○
...I would be **concerned** that important information needed to play is missing from the screen.	○	○	○	○	○

A404

Regarding how the interface appears...

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly agree
...the interface looks **clean** and **minimal**.	○	○	○	○	○
...there is **too much** on-screen information at once.	○	○	○	○	○
...the **game world** is visually dominant, not the interface elements.	○	○	○	○	○

A405

If I were playing with this interface...	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly agree
...I would try to **hide** or **reduce** on-screen interface elements.	○	○	○	○	○
...I would **like** to play a game with an interface like this.	○	○	○	○	○

Page 05

C2

A501

Please watch the following video clip carefully and in full screen.

Afterwards, you will be asked questions about this Clip.

Game Title: Outer Worlds

If the video does not load, click here.

A613

Game familiarity	Never seen or played	Seen it, but never played	Played a little / know the basics	Played several times	Played a lot / know it very well
How familiar are you with this game?	○	○	○	○	○

A612

What we mean by interface (HUD)

*In video games, a **head-up display (HUD)** or in this study **interface** is the on-screen overlay that shows essential gameplay information—such as health, ammo, objectives, and minimaps—so players can make decisions without leaving the main action.*

A614

In the presented clip, with this interface...

	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
...I would feel **absorbed** in the gameplay.	○	○	○	○	○
...it would be **easy** for me to **tune out** my real-world surroundings.	○	○	○	○	○
...I would feel **present** in the game world.	○	○	○	○	○
...it would be **easy** for me to **stay focused** on the gameplay.	○	○	○	○	○

A615

Regarding the on-screen interface in the clip...

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly agree
...it is **clear** to me what is happening in the situation shown.	○	○	○	○	○
...the interface **provides** the information I would need to play effectively.	○	○	○	○	○
...I would be **concerned** that important information needed to play is missing from the screen.	○	○	○	○	○

A616

Regarding how the interface appears...

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly agree
...the interface looks **clean** and **minimal**.	○	○	○	○	○
...there is **too much** on-screen information at once.	○	○	○	○	○
...the **game world** is visually dominant, not the interface elements.	○	○	○	○	○

A617

If I were playing with this interface...	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly agree
...I would try to **hide** or **reduce** on-screen interface elements.	○	○	○	○	○
...I would **like** to play a game with an interface like this.	○	○	○	○	○

Page 06

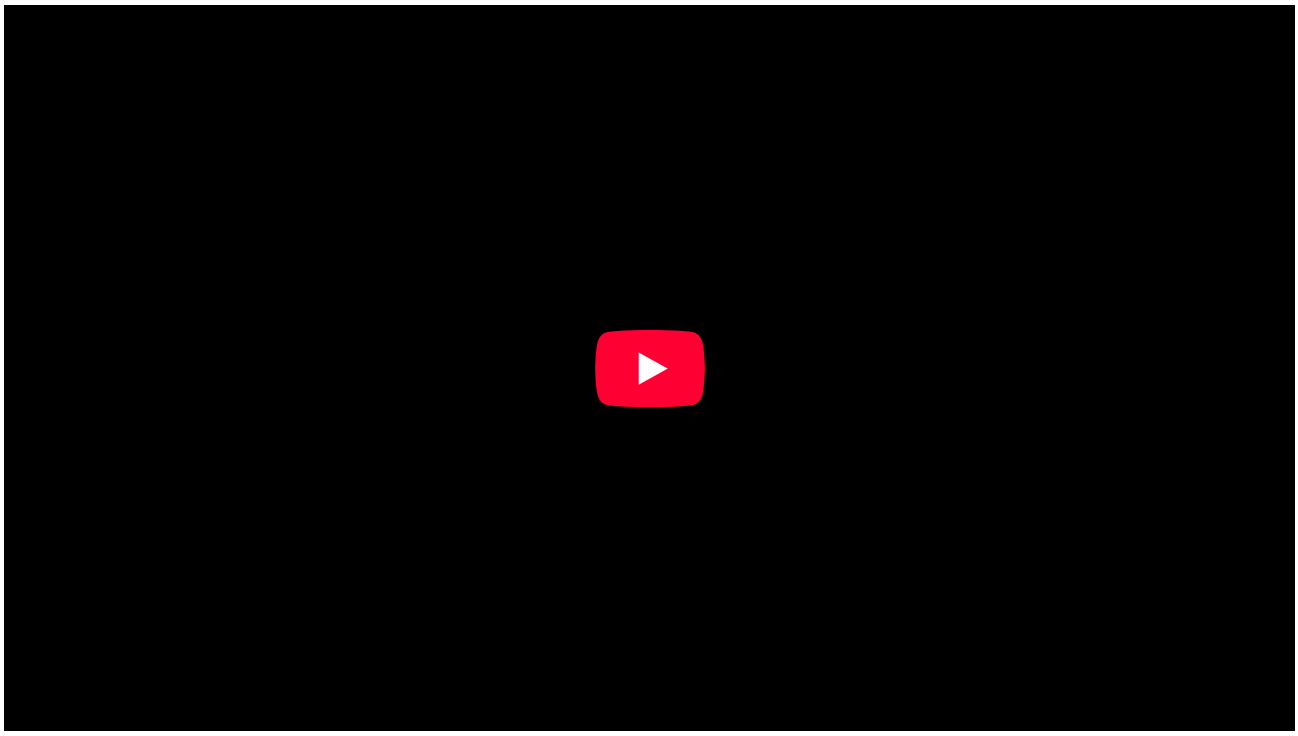
C3

A606

Please watch the following video clip carefully and in full screen.

Afterwards, you will be asked questions about this Clip.

Game Title: Witcher 3



If the video does not load, click here.

A508

Game familiarity

	Never seen or played	Seen it, but never played	Played a little / know the basics	Played several times	Played a lot / know it very well
How familiar are you with this game?	○	○	○	○	○

A507

What we mean by interface (HUD)

*In video games, a **head-up display (HUD)** or in this study **interface** is the on-screen overlay that shows essential gameplay information—such as health, ammo, objectives, and minimaps—so players can make decisions without leaving the main action.*

A509

In the presented clip, with this interface...

	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
...I would feel **absorbed** in the gameplay.	○	○	○	○	○
...it would be **easy** for me to **tune out** my real-world surroundings.	○	○	○	○	○
...I would feel **present** in the game world.	○	○	○	○	○
...it would be **easy** for me to **stay focused** on the gameplay.	○	○	○	○	○

A510

Regarding the on-screen interface in the clip...

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly agree
...it is **clear** to me what is happening in the situation shown.	○	○	○	○	○
...the interface **provides** the information I would need to play effectively.	○	○	○	○	○
...I would be **concerned** that important information needed to play is missing from the screen.	○	○	○	○	○

A511

Regarding how the interface appears...

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly agree
...the interface looks **clean** and **minimal**.	○	○	○	○	○
...there is **too much** on-screen information at once.	○	○	○	○	○
...the **game world** is visually dominant, not the interface elements.	○	○	○	○	○

A512

If I were playing with this interface...	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly agree
...I would try to **hide** or **reduce** on-screen interface elements.	○	○	○	○	○
...I would **like** to play a game with an interface like this.	○	○	○	○	○

Page 07

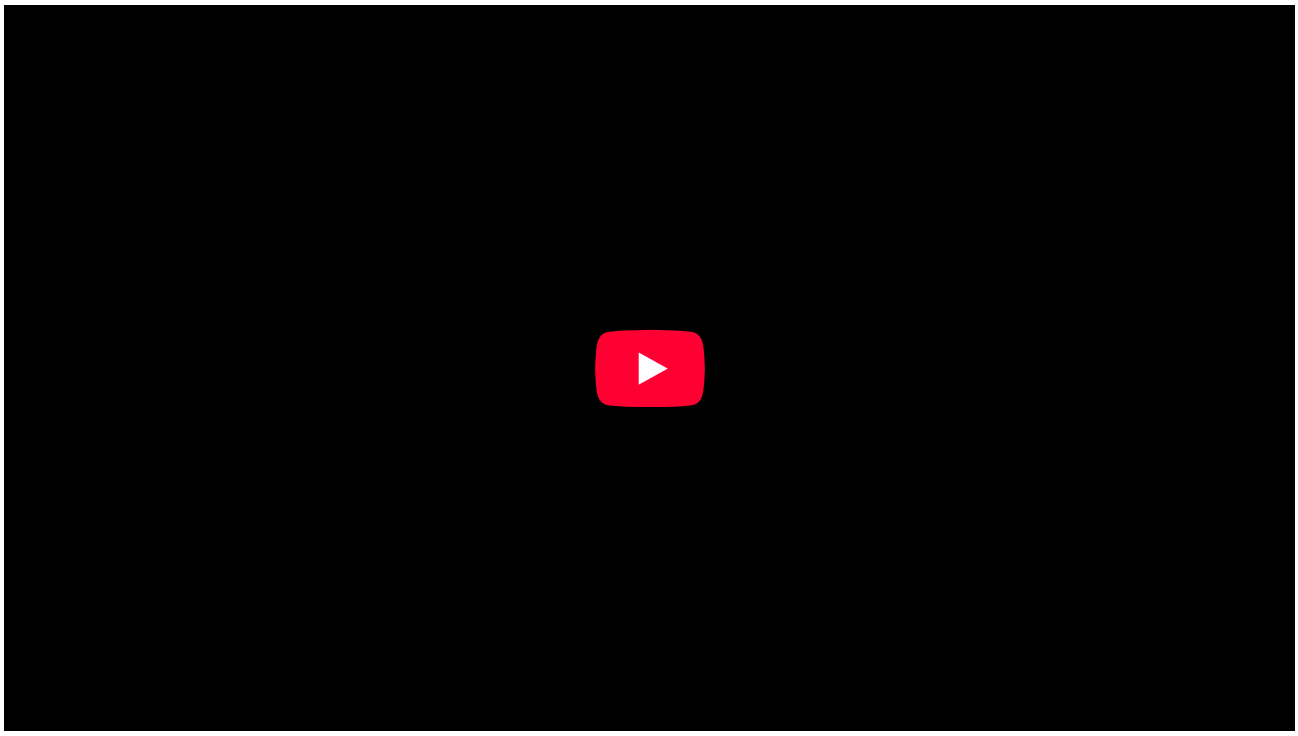
C4

A706

Please watch the following video clip carefully and in full screen.

Afterwards, you will be asked questions about this Clip.

Game Title: Monster Hunter World



If the video does not load, click here.

A708

Game familiarity

	Never seen or played	Seen it, but never played	Played a little / know the basics	Played several times	Played a lot / know it very well
How familiar are you with this game?	○	○	○	○	○

A707

What we mean by interface (HUD)

*In video games, a **head-up display (HUD)** or in this study **interface** is the on-screen overlay that shows essential gameplay information—such as health, ammo, objectives, and minimaps—so players can make decisions without leaving the main action.*

A709

In the presented clip, with this interface...

	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
...I would feel **absorbed** in the gameplay.	○	○	○	○	○
...it would be **easy** for me to **tune out** my real-world surroundings.	○	○	○	○	○
...I would feel **present** in the game world.	○	○	○	○	○
...it would be **easy** for me to **stay focused** on the gameplay.	○	○	○	○	○

A710

Regarding the on-screen interface in the clip...

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly agree
...it is **clear** to me what is happening in the situation shown.	○	○	○	○	○
...the interface **provides** the information I would need to play effectively.	○	○	○	○	○
...I would be **concerned** that important information needed to play is missing from the screen.	○	○	○	○	○

A711

Regarding how the interface appears...

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly agree
...the interface looks **clean** and **minimal**.	○	○	○	○	○
...there is **too much** on-screen information at once.	○	○	○	○	○
...the **game world** is visually dominant, not the interface elements.	○	○	○	○	○

A712

If I were playing with this interface...	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly agree
...I would try to **hide** or **reduce** on-screen interface elements.	○	○	○	○	○
...I would **like** to play a game with an interface like this.	○	○	○	○	○

Page 08

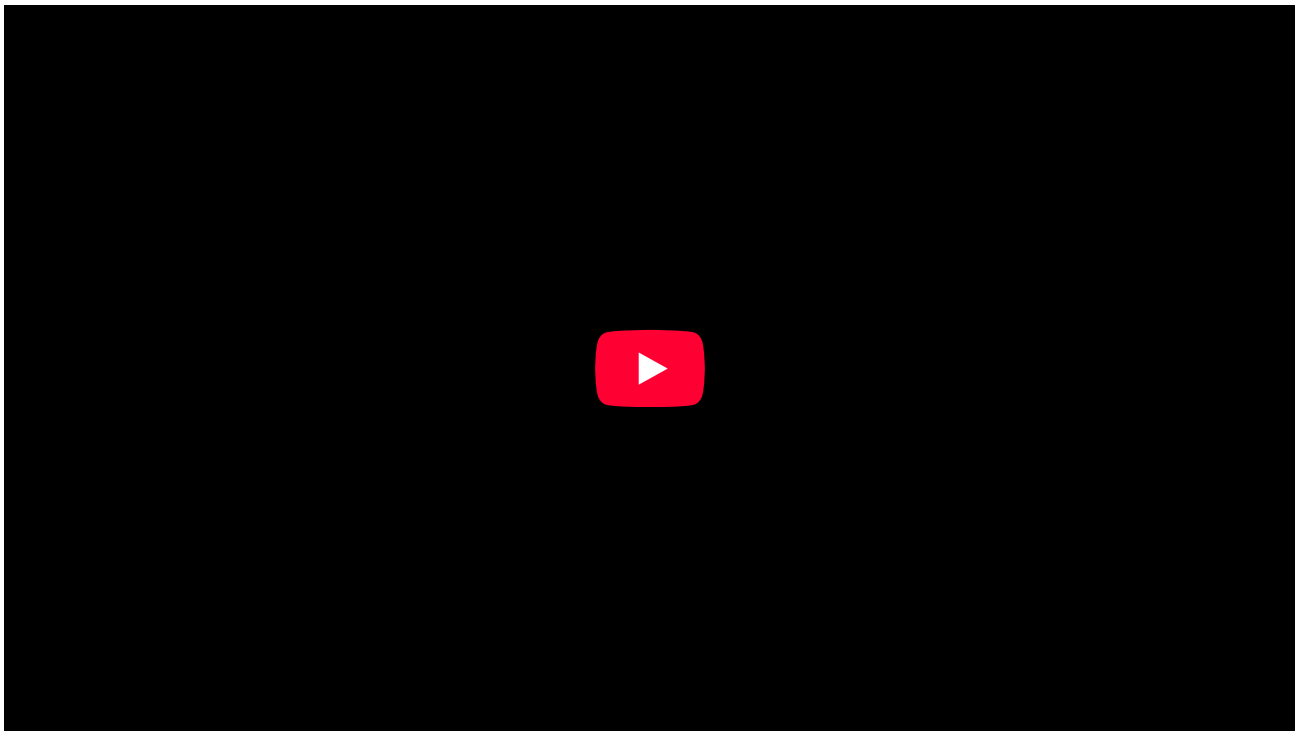
C5

A806

Please watch the following video clip carefully and in full screen.

Afterwards, you will be asked questions about this Clip.

Game Title: The Last of Us 2



If the video does not load, click here.

A808

Game familiarity

	Never seen or played	Seen it, but never played	Played a little / know the basics	Played several times	Played a lot / know it very well
How familiar are you with this game?	○	○	○	○	○

A807

What we mean by interface (HUD)

*In video games, a **head-up display (HUD)** or in this study **interface** is the on-screen overlay that shows essential gameplay information—such as health, ammo, objectives, and minimaps—so players can make decisions without leaving the main action.*

A809

In the presented clip, with this interface...

	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
...I would feel **absorbed** in the gameplay.	○	○	○	○	○
...it would be **easy** for me to **tune out** my real-world surroundings.	○	○	○	○	○
...I would feel **present** in the game world.	○	○	○	○	○
...it would be **easy** for me to **stay focused** on the gameplay.	○	○	○	○	○

A810

Regarding the on-screen interface in the clip...

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly agree
...it is **clear** to me what is happening in the situation shown.	○	○	○	○	○
...the interface **provides** the information I would need to play effectively.	○	○	○	○	○
...I would be **concerned** that important information needed to play is missing from the screen.	○	○	○	○	○

A811

Regarding how the interface appears...

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly agree
...the interface looks **clean** and **minimal**.	○	○	○	○	○
...there is **too much** on-screen information at once.	○	○	○	○	○
...the **game world** is visually dominant, not the interface elements.	○	○	○	○	○

A812

If I were playing with this interface...	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly agree
...I would try to **hide** or **reduce** on-screen interface elements.	○	○	○	○	○
...I would **like** to play a game with an interface like this.	○	○	○	○	○

Page 09

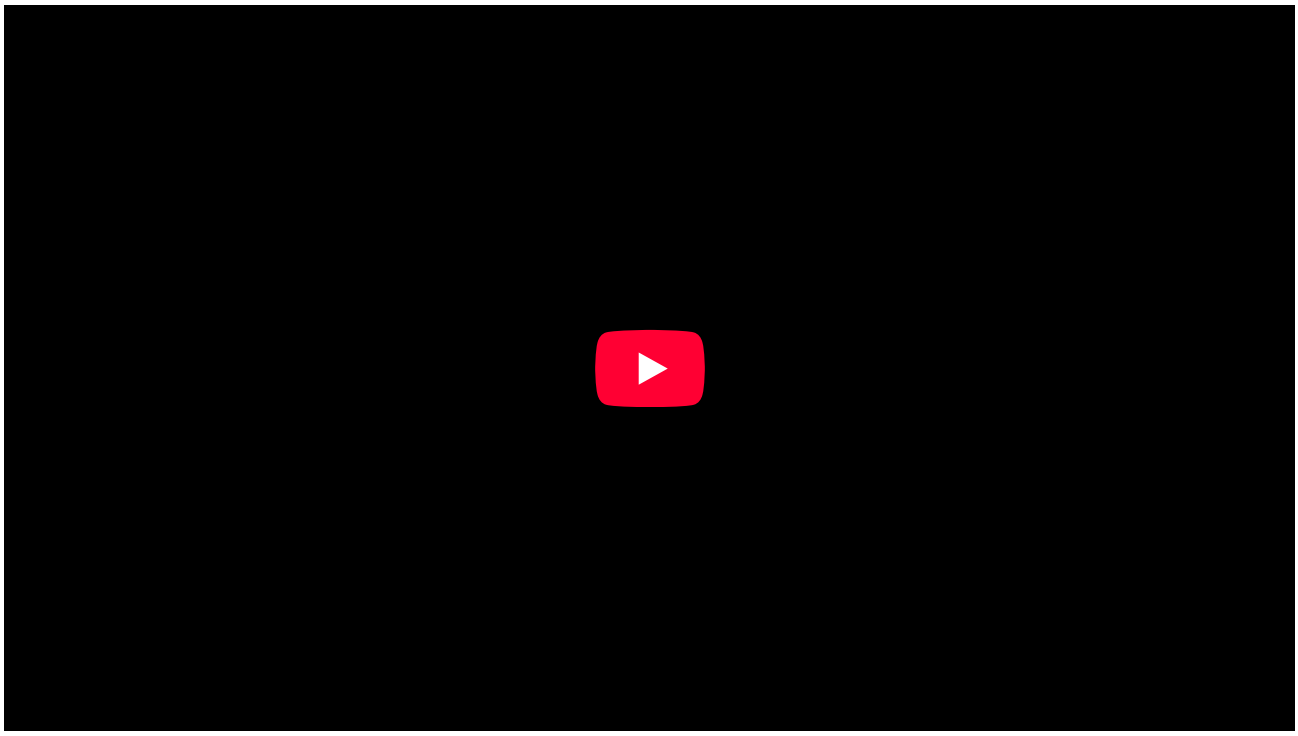
C6

A906

Please watch the following video clip carefully and in full screen.

Afterwards, you will be asked questions about this Clip.

Game Title: Red Dead Redemption 2



If the video does not load, click here.

A908

Game familiarity

	Never seen or played	Seen it, but never played	Played a little / know the basics	Played several times	Played a lot / know it very well
How familiar are you with this game?	○	○	○	○	○

A907

What we mean by interface (HUD)

*In video games, a **head-up display (HUD)** or in this study **interface** is the on-screen overlay that shows essential gameplay information—such as health, ammo, objectives, and minimaps—so players can make decisions without leaving the main action.*

A909

In the presented clip, with this interface...

	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
...I would feel **absorbed** in the gameplay.	○	○	○	○	○
...it would be **easy** for me to **tune out** my real-world surroundings.	○	○	○	○	○
...I would feel **present** in the game world.	○	○	○	○	○
...it would be **easy** for me to **stay focused** on the gameplay.	○	○	○	○	○

A910

Regarding the on-screen interface in the clip...

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly agree
...it is **clear** to me what is happening in the situation shown.	○	○	○	○	○
...the interface **provides** the information I would need to play effectively.	○	○	○	○	○
...I would be **concerned** that important information needed to play is missing from the screen.	○	○	○	○	○

A911

Regarding how the interface appears...

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly agree
...the interface looks **clean** and **minimal**.	○	○	○	○	○
...there is **too much** on-screen information at once.	○	○	○	○	○
...the **game world** is visually dominant, not the interface elements.	○	○	○	○	○

A912

If I were playing with this interface...

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly agree
...I would try to **hide** or **reduce** on-screen interface elements.	○	○	○	○	○
...I would **like** to play a game with an interface like this.	○	○	○	○	○

Page 10

UIPREF

Finally, regarding game interfaces (HUDs) in general... B101

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly agree
...I prefer game *interfaces (HUDs)* that display as **little information** as possible.	○	○	○	○	○
...when a game offers different *HUD* options, I usually choose the most **minimal setting**.	○	○	○	○	○

Which of the following have you done before? (please select all that apply) B102

- ☐ I have changed *HUD/UI* settings to **reduce** the amount of visible information
- ☐ I have changed *HUD/UI* settings to **increase** the amount of visible information
- ☐ I have used mods or external tools to **hide or reduce** UI elements

Last Page

Thank you for completing this questionnaire!

We would like to deeply thank you for helping us.

Your answers were submitted, you may close the browser window or tab now.
If you have further questions contact us at: s27jmeye@uni-bonn.de

Julian Meyer, Rheinische Friedrich-Wilhelms Universität Bonn – 2025